

Blackwood If you have an agreed suit, you can find out how many Aces (and Kings) partner holds by using a 4NT bid. A reply of 5♣ shows 0 or 4, 5♦ shows 1, 5♥ shows 2 and 5♠ shows 3.

If your side has all four Aces, bidding 5NT will repeat the process for Kings.

The Replier can show one Ace plus a Void by bidding 6 of the Void suit if it ranks below the agreed trump, or 6 of the trump suit if the Void ranks above.

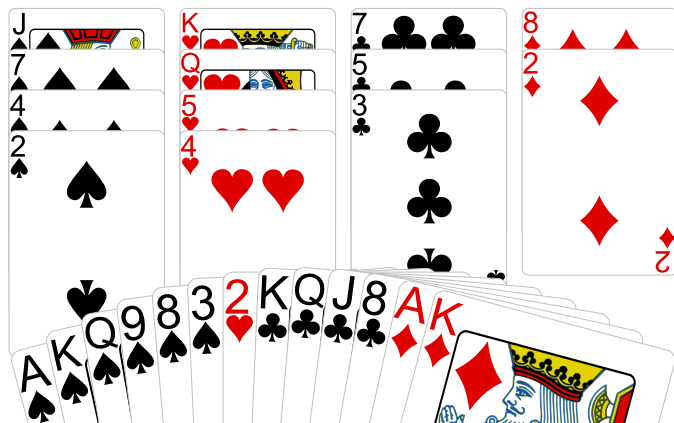
A Reply of 5NT shows two Aces plus a Void in some suit.

Gerber : Similar to Blackwood, this convention uses a 4♣ bid to initiate the Ace question, with 4♦ showing 0 or 4, 4♥ showing 1, 4♠ showing 2 and 4NT showing 3.

Not all 4♣ bids are Gerber, and deciding which ones are needs to be addressed by the partnership. For these Deals 4♣ is Gerber only when it follows a bid of 1NT or 2NT.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these two conventions.

Deal 1 Ctr: 5♠ Goal: at most ____ losers



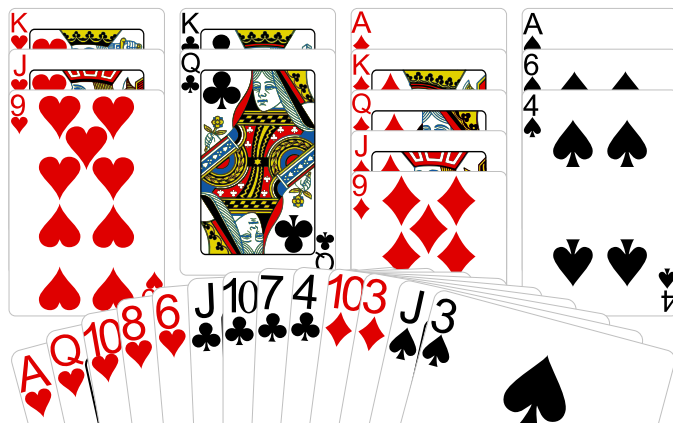
Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 2 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



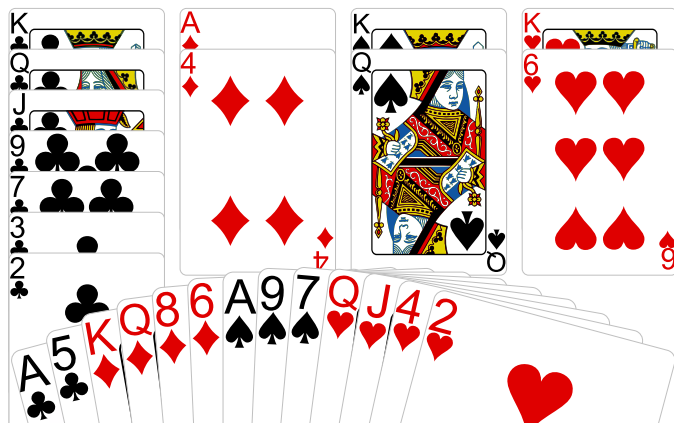
Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 3 Ctr: 6NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 4 Ctr: 7NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 5♠

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 6NT

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: West

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 5♥

Declarer: North

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T
♥ A T 8 3
♦ 7 6 5 4 3
♣ A 9 6

22
8 4
6

♠ A K Q 9 8 3
♥ 2
♦ A K
♣ K Q J 8



♠ J 7 4 2
♥ K Q 5 4
♦ 8 2
♣ 7 5 3

♠ 6 5
♥ J 9 7 6
♦ Q J T 9
♣ T 4 2

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			
5♠ by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 1

SOUTH's 3♠ supporting bid is enough to convince NORTH to make a slam try.

NORTH bids Blackwood 4NT. If SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH plans to bid 6♠, but

when SOUTH bids 5♣ NORTH settles for 5♠

Deal 2

West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A 6 4
♥ K J 9
♦ A K Q J 9
♣ K Q

4
23 8
5

♠ T 8 2
♥ 7 5 4 2
♦ 6 4
♣ A 6 3 2

N
W E
S

♠ K Q 9 7 5
♥ 3
♦ 8 7 5 2
♣ 9 8 5

♠ J 3
♥ A Q T 8 6
♦ T 3
♣ J T 7 4

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♦	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			
6♥ by East			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 2
EAST makes a positive 3

♥

response to WEST's 2♣ opener.

This promises at least 8 points and a 5-card suit with two or more honors.

WEST only needs to know one thing - how many Aces in the EAST hand.

A Blackwood 4NT tells her the answer is one, so she bids 6

♥

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Deal 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 8 3 2

♥ T 7 3

♦ J 9 3 2

♣ 6 4

18

2 4

16

♠ K Q

♥ K 6

♦ A 4

♣ K Q J 9 7 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 9 7

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ K Q 8 6

♣ A 5

♠ T 6 5 4

♥ A 9 8 5

♦ T 7 5

♣ T 8

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 3

When SOUTH opens 1NT, point-count alone tells NORTH that 6NT can surely be made.

SOUTH is bound to hold at least two Aces. But NORTH doesn't want to miss a Grand slam.

NORTH bids 4♣, (Gerber), and SOUTH admits to just two Aces.

So NORTH settles for the small slam.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			

Deal 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K Q 6 4 3
 ♥ K 5
 ♦ K 7 3
 ♣ A K

4
 22 12
 2

♠ T 7
 ♥ Q T 2
 ♦ J 6 5 2
 ♣ J 6 4 3

N
 W E
 S

♠ 8
 ♥ 9 8 6
 ♦ T 9 8 4
 ♣ Q T 7 5 2

♠ J 9 5 2
 ♥ A J 7 4 3
 ♦ A Q
 ♣ 9 8

West	North	East	South
		1♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4NT	Pass	5♥	Pass
7NT			
All Pass			
7NT by West			

Baker Bidpractice/Set7 4

WEST has a powerhouse and knows she will reach a slam somewhere. When EAST

supports the ♠s, it seems she has found her spot.

Blackwood tells her that EAST has two Aces.

She can see there are 12 tricks available and decides to take a chance that

EAST will have a thirteenth trick somewhere among his opening hand points.

She bids 7NT.

Deal 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 8 6
 ♥ 7 2
 ♦ 5 4
 ♣ A 9 4 3 2

8
 6 4
 22

♠ J 7 3
 ♥ A J T 9 8
 ♦ 8 3 2
 ♣ Q 8



♠ A K 2
 ♥ K Q 6 5
 ♦ K Q J
 ♣ K J 6

♠ T 5 4
 ♥ 4 3
 ♦ A T 9 7 6
 ♣ T 7 5

Baker Bidpractice/Set 7 5

SOUTH is tempted to go right to 6



when she hears NORTH's positive

response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because NORTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.

West	North	East	South
			2 ♣
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♦	Pass	5 ♥
All Pass			
5 ♥ by North			